

Deal 2 Ctr: **6♣** Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: **4♥** Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♣

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4
 ♥ K J 10 3
 ♦ 9 7 4
 ♣ 6 2

♠ -

♥ A 5 2

♦ A K 6

♣ A K Q J 7 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 6 2

♥ Q 9 8

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ 10 3

♠ A K Q 7 3

♥ 7 6 4

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 9 8

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♣	Pass	3NT
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			
6♣ by North			

North is to play 6♣. East leads the ♦Q.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 3

Partner's hand didn't turn out to be what you hoped for, you had in mind maybe the ♥K and ♦Q.

But this is what you got. First, be thankful East led a ♦ rather than a ♥. Second, see if you can find a way to fight yourself over to dummy and those three beautiful ♠s.

You have two possibilities for a ♣ entry, but you can only try one of them as you will see.

You can play a high ♣ and hope somebody plays the singleton ♣10. Then your ♣9 would be an entry. If this works you would probably make all 13 tricks, but the chances are very slim.

You can play a low ♣ to dummy's ♣8. Assuming a defender takes the ♣10 you can win his return and enter dummy with the ♣9. This play is guaranteed to give you the entry and is the one you should choose.

Just in case you were wondering about the chances of that singleton ♣10, here is how you would figure it out.

When you are missing 4 cards the probability of a 3-1 split is about 50%.

But the singleton can be any one of four cards - in this case it can be the ♣10, ♣6, ♣3 or ♣2. So the chance of one of the opponents holding specifically the singleton ♣10 is only one-fourth of 50%, about 12.5%.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 6 5

♣ K Q J 8 7 5 3

♠ Q 10 6 5 2

♥ 6 5 2

♦ A Q 7

♣ 9 4



♠ 8 3

♥ A K J 9 8 7

♦ K 10 4 3

♣ A

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 3

♦ J 9 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by East

hand, then unblock the ♣A, then pull trumps in 3 rounds ending in dummy. And run all those ♣ tricks. If South plays a trump or a ♣ the result will be the same. The defense can get one ♦ trick if they take it right now, but you still make your contract.

East is to play 4 ♥. South leads the ♠A, then ♠K.

Losers: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 0 ♦ = 3? ♣ = 0 Total = 4?

This is the kind of hand that can get really messy if you aren't careful. You could ruff the ♠, then try to ruff some ♦s, but the defense can prevent you by leading trumps when you give up the ♦ tricks.

All in all a much better plan is to use dummy's ♣ suit after you unblock the Ace. The only flaw with that idea is that when you ruff the ♠, unblock the ♣A, then play two rounds of trumps ending in dummy, there will still be a trump left out. And the defender might ruff a ♣ before you can take the discards you need. Do you see a way around this?

Do NOT ruff the second ♠ in dummy, just discard a ♦. If South plays a third ♠ you will ruff in your

It is an important concept. When you have to use a trump as a later entry you could thwart your own plan by ruffing.